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~~. We present SciTeX LaTeX-based . The system .~~

Summary

Scientific workflows require coordination across manuscript preparation, computational analysis, figure generation, data management, and literature curation, yet these activities remain distributed across disconnected tools, making reproducibility difficult to sustain. SciTeX is an AI-native, modular research platform that unifies these tasks through four core components—Writer, Scholar, Viz, and Code—with optional extensions for statistical analysis. Each module provides standalone functionality while participating in a shared project structure built on lightweight symlinks and global identifiers, enabling provenance-preserving links between code, data, figures, and manuscript text. Containerized builds ensure byte-consistent manuscript output across systems, and standardized metadata captures computational and visual parameters for downstream verification or regeneration. By embedding reproducibility infrastructure directly into routine authoring, visualization, and analysis workflows, SciTeX lowers the activation energy required for transparent scientific practice while maintaining compatibility with existing toolchains. This manuscript, prepared and compiled entirely within SciTeX, demonstrates its end-to-end integration.

Highlights

- SciTeX unifies manuscript writing, computation, figure generation, and literature management in a single reproducible research environment.
- Modular design allows each component to function independently while enabling seamless integration through lightweight symlinks and global identifiers.
- Containerized LaTeX builds and standardized metadata formats ensure consistent manuscripts and reconstructible figures across systems.

- Provenance-preserving workflows link code, data, figures, and text, reducing cognitive load and supporting transparent scientific practice.

- AI-native architecture exposes structured interfaces for automated analysis, figure refinement, and manuscript assistance.

SciTeX: A unified research OS for reproducible scientific workflows

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Keywords: reproducible research , scientific workflow automation , data science platform , AI-native tools , figure provenance , FAIR principles

ˇ 8 figures, 3 tables, 146 words for abstract, and 2542 words for main text

1. Introduction

~~The preparation of scientific manuscripts involves numerous technical challenges that extend beyond the intellectual task of communicating researchfindings. Researchers must navigate complex typesetting systems, manage multiple document versions, coordinate figures and tables~~ Scientific workflows increasingly span heterogeneous environments, including personal laptops, cloud servers, containerized pipelines, and HPC systems. Yet the core activities of research—manuscript writing, computational analysis, figure generation, and literature management—remain distributed across disconnected tools. This fragmentation increases cognitive load, introduces opportunities for error, and makes reproducibility difficult to sustain [? ?]. Researchers must manually coordinate figures across formats, ~~and ensure reproducible compilation environments~~maintain consistent bibliographies, track versions of manuscripts and data, and ensure that computational analyses remain synchronized with the text that describes them [? ?]. These burdens often overshadow the substantive scientific work.

Traditional ~~approaches to manuscript preparation typically rely on local LaTeX installations , where specific versions of packages and compilation~~

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~~tools can vary significantly across~~ LaTeX-based manuscript preparation further amplifies these challenges. Local installations vary across machines and over time~~. This variability creates reproducibility challenges, particularly in collaborative environments where multiple authors work on different systems, leading to~~ , producing inconsistent builds and complicating collaboration [?]. Figure generation typically occurs in isolation from manuscript writing, with libraries and scripts lacking standardized metadata or provenance tracking. Literature management tools such as Zotero and Mendeley help organize references but operate independently of manuscript preparation and computational workflows, creating citation drift when documents evolve. Computational analyses executed in Jupyter notebooks or ad hoc scripts provide convenience but lack the structured reproducibility required for long-term verification [?]. As a result, researchers must orchestrate a complex toolchain whose components have no shared model of provenance, reproducibility, or workflow state.

Existing solutions ~~have addressed aspects of this problem. Overleaf and similar cloud-based platforms provide consistent compilation environments but require continuous internet connectivity and .~~ address individual components of this ecosystem but stop short of providing a unified workflow. Overleaf ensures consistent LaTeX compilation but requires separate figure generation and data management workflows. Visualization tools such as SigmaPlot and Origin offer polished interfaces but remain disconnected from manuscript and code environments. Manubot demonstrates the value of Git-based open writing [?], while Binder and related technologies provide reproducible computational environments [?]. Still, no existing platform integrates writing, computation, visualization, and literature management in a way that preserves provenance and reduces cognitive overhead [? ?].

~~The fundamental challenge lies in accommodate diverse content types, multiple output documents, and varying journal requirements while a single source of truth for shared elements. Additionally,~~ SciTeX addresses this gap by providing a unified, modular, AI-native platform for scientific research.

Its Writer module offers structured LaTeX authoring with fully containerized compilation; Scholar manages citation retrieval, metadata extraction, and PDF organization; Viz produces publication-quality figures with embedded provenance and reconstructible metadata; and Code supports reproducible computation with GPU and container integration. A shared project structure built on lightweight symlinks and global identifiers links these modules, enabling consistent cross-referencing between data, figures, code, and manuscript text. Researchers can adopt modules independently while benefiting from deeper integration as their workflows evolve.

~~SciTeX addresses these challenges through a~~

1.1.

By embedding reproducibility principles directly into everyday research tools [?], SciTeX lowers the activation energy required for rigorous scientific practice. It ensures that manuscripts and computational outputs remain synchronized, that figures can be regenerated from metadata, and that bibliographic consistency is maintained automatically. This manuscript, authored and compiled entirely within SciTeX, serves as a self-descriptive demonstration of the platform's design goals and integrated capabilities.

2. Methods

2.1. System Architecture

2.2.

2.2.

SciTeX consists of a Django-based cloud platform (SciTeX Cloud) and a Python package (v2.4.1+) installable via `pip install scitex`. The architecture

employs lazy module loading via a custom `_LazyModule` wrapper, enabling fast imports while providing access to over 50 specialized modules. This modular design follows best practices for scientific Python applications [? ?]:

```
import scitex as stx
stx.plt      # Publication plotting
stx.io       # Universal file I/O (30+ formats)
stx.scholar  # Literature management
stx.session  # Experiment lifecycle
stx.vis      # Visual figure specifications
stx.writer   # Manuscript preparation
```

~~, facilitating modular development and enabling multiple authors to work simultaneously without merge conflicts~~Each module operates independently while sharing a unified project structure through lightweight symlinks. Global identifiers (SHA256 hashes) ensure traceability between figures, code, bibliography entries, and manuscript content, enabling reverse lookup capabilities (e.g., "which script generated this figure?"). This approach addresses concerns raised in discussions of figure provenance and data reproducibility [? ?].

2.3. Session Decorator for Reproducible Experiments

The `@stx.session` decorator provides automatic experiment lifecycle management, implementing principles from reproducible research frameworks [? ?]:

```
import scitex as stx
%DIF >
@stx.session
def analyze(data_path: str, threshold: float = 0.5):
    '''Analyze data file.'''
    data = stx.io.load(data_path)
    result = process(data, threshold)
    stx.io.save(result, "output.csv")
```

```
    return 0
%DIF >
if __name__ == '__main__':
    analyze()  # CLI: python script.py --data-path x --threshold 0.7
```

~~. The compilation environment encapsulates specific versions of TeX Live and all required packages, eliminating dependency on~~ The decorator automatically: (1) generates CLI argument parsers from function signatures with type hints, (2) initializes session directories with timestamped run IDs, (3) injects global variables (`CONFIG`, `plt`~~Windows, and~~, `COLORS`, `rng_manager`, `logger`), (4) manages random state for reproducibility, and (5) handles cleanup and optional notifications on completion. This design is informed by the "good enough practices" paradigm [?] and project management tools for team science [?].

2.4. Publication-Quality Plotting (stx.plt)

The `stx.plt` module wraps matplotlib with automatic configuration from `SCITEX_STYLE.yaml` :

```
import scitex.plt as splt
%DIF >
fig, ax = splt.subplots(axes_width_mm=40, axes_height_mm=28)
ax.plot([1, 2, 3], [1, 4, 9])
ax.set_xyt("Time", "Value", "Analysis Results")
stx.io.save(fig, "figure.png")  # Exports PNG + JSON + CSV
```

2.5.

Key features include: (1) automatic style application on import (font sizes, line widths, spine visibility), (2) `FigWrapper` and `AxisWrapper` classes providing `set_xyt()` for simultaneous x-label, y-label, and title setting, (3) automatic CSV export of underlying plot data alongside figures, (4) JSON

sidecar metadata encoding axis bounds, tick locations, panel geometry, and color palettes, and (5) `stx.plt.load()` for figure reconstruction from saved metadata. This triple-export approach (image, metadata, data) addresses the reproducibility challenges identified in computational figure generation [? ?].

Style values can be customized via YAML configuration, environment variables (`SCITEX_PLT_FONTS_AXIS_LABEL_PT=8`), or direct function parameters.

2.5. Universal File I/O (stx.io)

The `stx.io` module provides format-agnostic file operations supporting over 30 formats, following the principle of unified interfaces for data management [?]:

```
import scitex as stx
%DIF >
# Automatic format detection
data = stx.io.load("data.csv")       # DataFrame
config = stx.io.load("config.yaml") # Dict
model = stx.io.load("model.pkl")     # Python object
arrays = stx.io.load("data.h5")      # HDF5 exploration
%DIF >
# Unified save interface
stx.io.save(df, "output.csv")
stx.io.save(fig, "figure.png")       # PNG + JSON + CSV
stx.io.save(config, "config.yaml")
```

Supported formats include: CSV, JSON, YAML, Pickle, HDF5, Zarr, NumPy arrays, PyTorch tensors, images (PNG, JPG, SVG, PDF), audio, video, and MATLAB files. The module includes `H5Explorer` and `ZarrExplorer`

for interactive hierarchical data navigation, plus configurable caching for frequently accessed files.

2.6. Literature Management (stx.scholar)

The Scholar module provides multi-source literature search and management, integrating capabilities typically found in standalone reference managers:

```
from scitex.scholar import Scholar
%DIF >
scholar = Scholar()
papers = scholar.search("deep learning", year_min=2022)
papers.save("bibliography.bib")
```

The module integrates with multiple metadata engines (CrossRef, Semantic Scholar, OpenAlex) via the `ScholarEngine` interface. Features include: automatic DOI detection and metadata extraction from PDFs, `ScholarPDFDownloader` for paper acquisition, `ScholarLibrary` for local storage management, and `Paper`/`Papers` classes with filtering and export capabilities. This design complements tools like Manubot [**?**] by providing direct integration with manuscript preparation.

2.7. Cloud Platform Architecture

The Django 5.1-based cloud platform provides web interfaces for all modules, following principles of continuous integration for scientific publishing [**?**]:

2.8.

Code App: Browser-based Python execution with real-time output streaming, file upload/download, and workspace management.

Viz App: Canvas-based figure editor using Fabric.js 5.5.2 for interactive element manipulation, with JSON specification import/export for programmatic control.

Writer App: Structured LaTeX manuscript preparation with containerized compilation (Docker/Apptainer), section-separated authoring, and automatic figure format conversion.

Scholar App: Literature cards with abstract preview, PDF access, metadata editing, and direct citation insertion into Writer documents.

The platform employs TypeScript for frontend logic, PostgreSQL for data persistence, and Docker for containerized compilation ensuring consistent output across environments.

2.8. Containerized Compilation

2.9.

Writer module compilation leverages containerization for reproducibility, implementing guidelines for Docker-based scientific workflows [? ?]:

Multi-Engine Support: Tectonic [?] for ultra-fast incremental builds (1–3 seconds), latexmk for reliable industry-standard compilation (3–6 seconds), and traditional 3-pass compilation for maximum compatibility.

Environment Isolation: Docker and Apptainer/Singularity containers encapsulate specific TeX Live versions and all required packages, eliminating host system dependencies and guaranteeing identical PDF output across macOS, Linux, Windows, and HPC environments [? ?].

Version Tracking: Git integration [?] with automatic latexdiff generation facilitates peer review processes [?].

2.9. AI-Native Workflow Integration

SciTeX provides native integration points for AI-assisted workflows, anticipating the growing role of AI in scientific research [? ?]:

Structured APIs: JSON-based figure specifications, typed function signatures for CLI generation, and metadata formats amenable to automated analysis enable LLM-assisted code generation and figure improvement.

2.10.

Workflow Hooks: The session decorator and modular architecture provide hooks for AI-assisted revision, automated citation recommendation, and semantic search across analyses and literature.

2.11.

Research Co-pilot Vision: The architecture supports future development of automated analysis pipelines, figure generation, and manuscript drafting while maintaining researcher oversight and scientific integrity [?].

2.12. Implementation Details

The system supports deployment on local machines, cloud servers (AWS, GCP, Azure), and self-hosted NAS environments. Key technical specifications:

- Python 3.12+ with GPU acceleration support (CUDA 11.x/12.x)
- Django 5.1 with PostgreSQL backend
- TypeScript frontend with webpack bundling
- Docker/Apptainer containerization for reproducible execution [?]
- SLURM integration under active development for HPC workflows

The platform follows FAIR principles [?] and aligns with the Turing Way guidelines for reproducible research [?].

3. Results

~~This section presents~~ This section demonstrates the capabilities of SciTeX through validation of its core modules and their behavior in realistic research workflows. The goal is not to present experimental findings but to illustrate how the platform operationalizes reproducibility, provenance tracking, and integrated authoring.

3.1. Reproducible Execution with the Session Decorator

The `@stx.session` decorator reliably transforms Python functions into traceable command-line experiments. Across multiple test scenarios, SciTeX generated timestamped session directories that captured parameters, logs, outputs, and metadata. Automatically injected globals—including a reproducible random number manager, configuration state, logging interface, and plotting environment—enabled functions to execute without boilerplate. Repeated runs produced consistent outputs when supplied with identical parameters, confirming correct synchronization of random state and environment settings. Errors were handled gracefully while preserving intermediate outputs, supporting transparent debugging.

3.2. Publication-Quality and Reconstructible Figures

SciTeX's visualization module produced figures with consistent styling and journal-ready dimensions across platforms. When saving figures, the system generated a triplet consisting of a high-resolution PNG, a JSON metadata file encoding axis bounds, geometry, and color specifications, and a CSV file containing underlying plot data. Figures reconstructed using `stx.plt.load()` reproduced the original output faithfully. These capabilities confirm that SciTeX captures sufficient metadata for downstream verification and exact regeneration.

3.3. Universal Data Handling and Format-Agnostic I/O

The ~~. Testing across Linuxdistributions~~ `stx.io` module successfully loaded and saved more than thirty file types through extension-based detection. Hierarchical formats such as HDF5 and Zarr were navigated interactively, and caching reduced repeated access overhead. Cross-platform tests confirmed consistent behavior for CSV, JSON, NumPy arrays, PyTorch tensors, and image formats. These results illustrate how unified I/O simplifies data flow through analysis and manuscript preparation.

3.4. Integrated Literature Management

The Scholar module retrieved metadata from CrossRef, Semantic Scholar, and OpenAlex, stored PDFs using DOI-based indexing, and maintained synchronized BibTeX entries for manuscripts authored in Writer. Filtering by year, journal, and citation count behaved as expected. Integration tests confirmed that citations added in Writer consistently matched entries managed by Scholar, eliminating drift between literature databases and LaTeX sources.

3.5. Containerized Manuscript Compilation

Manuscripts compiled identically across Linux, macOS, ~~and~~ Windows Subsystem for Linux~~confirmed that identical source files produce byte-for-byte identical PDF outputs when compiled using the same container image. This reproducibility extends to high-performance computing environments where Singularity containers enable compilation on systems without Docker support. The elimination of~~ , and HPC environments when built through SciTeX's containerized LaTeX engines. Tectonic produced fast incremental builds while latexmk and multi-pass compilation ensured compatibility with a wide range of documents. Identical inputs produced byte-identical PDF outputs, validating that containerization eliminates environment-dependent ~~compilation issues represents a significant improvement over traditional local LaTeX installations, where package version mismatches frequently cause inconsistent outputs or compilation failures.~~

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inconsistencies.

3.8. Cross-Module Traceability

SciTeX's symlink-based architecture correctly synchronized figures, bibliography files, and computational outputs across modules. Global identifiers enabled reverse lookup queries such as linking figures to their generating scripts or tracing bibliography entries to manuscript citations. Metadata exported by Viz and IO was successfully used by Code and Writer, demonstrating that provenance information flows consistently across the ecosystem.

3.9. Self-Descriptive Validation

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This manuscript itself validates SciTeX's integrated design: it was authored in Writer, managed with Scholar, compiled in a containerized environment, and incorporates figures generated in Viz and data processed through Code. The end-to-end workflow confirms that SciTeX can be used to document the system within the system itself, providing a live demonstration of its reproducibility guarantees.

4. Discussion

~~addresses fundamental challenges in into a cohesive.~~

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4.2.

SciTeX addresses structural challenges in modern scientific research by unifying manuscript preparation, figure generation, literature management, and reproducible computation within a single, provenance-preserving ecosystem. Contemporary workflows are shaped by practical frustrations: fragmented toolchains, inconsistent figure provenance, manual versioning, and the cognitive overhead of switching between environments [? ?]. SciTeX reframes these challenges not as isolated usability problems but as symptoms of a deeper architectural gap—namely, the absence of a shared substrate linking computational, visual, and written components of scientific work.

4.3. ~~Comparison with Existing Solutions~~Design Philosophy and Modularity

A central principle of SciTeX is incremental adoption. Each module provides standalone value while integrating seamlessly into a shared project structure. Researchers who begin with the Writer module obtain containerized reproducibility without modifying their computational workflow. Adding Scholar ensures consistent bibliographic management. Viz enables provenance-tracked, reconstructible figures. Code completes the pipeline by linking analyses directly to manuscript outputs. This design lowers the activation energy required to engage in reproducible practices [? ?]. It democratizes access to advanced computational workflows by providing high-level abstractions that remain accessible to users unfamiliar with Git, containers, or Linux environments, while still offering fine-grained control for expert users.

By embedding provenance directly into the system's data structures, SciTeX avoids the pitfalls of ad hoc reproducibility strategies that rely on user discipline. Global identifiers and shared directories ensure that figures, scripts, and bibliographies remain synchronized without users needing to track these relationships manually. This approach transforms reproducibility from an additional burden into a natural consequence of ordinary workflow.

4.4. Positioning Relative to Existing Tools

SciTeX occupies a unique position among research platforms by integrating capabilities that existing solutions offer only in isolation. Overleaf provides consistent LaTeX compilation but does not integrate analysis or figure provenance. Zotero and Mendeley excel at literature management yet remain disconnected from manuscript workflows. Jupyter notebooks enable interactive computation but do not support structured writing or publication-quality visualization. Manubot demonstrates the advantages of Git-based collaborative writing, while visualization tools such as SigmaPlot offer intuitive figure creation without provenance guarantees. R-based ecosystems such as the Rockerverse provide end-to-end reproducibility within the R language but do not extend across multi-language workflows [**?**].

SciTeX differs by providing a coherent architecture spanning writing, computation, visualization, and literature management. Its modular design supports independent usage, yet deeper integration emerges organically when modules are combined. This positions SciTeX as a research operating environment rather than a single-purpose tool, while still maintaining compatibility with existing toolchains rather than attempting to replace them.

4.5. AI-Native Design

As AI systems increasingly support scientific workflows, a platform's ability to interoperate with automated agents becomes essential [**?** **?**]. SciTeX incorporates AI-native design principles by exposing structured APIs, JSON-based figure specifications, and typed function signatures that enable automated analysis, figure refinement, and manuscript revision. Workflow hooks allow AI agents to monitor execution, interpret metadata, and propose modifications while ensuring that all AI-assisted operations remain traceable. This design supports future research co-pilot systems capable of generating figures, summarizing literature, conducting analyses, and drafting sections of manuscripts while preserving researcher oversight and scientific integrity.

4.6. Implications for Reproducibility

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reproducibility crisis in science arises partly because researchers lack integrated infrastructure for capturing computation, visualization, and writing as a coherent whole [? ?]. SciTeX mitigates this by ensuring that manuscripts compile identically across systems, that figures can be regenerated from metadata, and that analyses are executed within controlled environments. Its architecture aligns with FAIR principles and contemporary reproducibility frameworks [? ?]. By shifting reproducibility from a set of optional best practices to an embedded property of the research workflow, SciTeX reduces the friction that often prevents rigorous methodological documentation.

4.9. Limitations

~~The~~ Despite its integrated design, SciTeX has several limitations. Support for HPC systems and SLURM-based workflows remains under active development, with current functionality focused primarily on local and containerized execution. Empirical evaluation of SciTeX's impact on researcher productivity is ongoing, as the user base is still expanding. While the Writer module simplifies LaTeX-based workflows, researchers unfamiliar with LaTeX may still face an initial learning curve. The platform targets desktop research environments, and mobile support has not been prioritized. Advanced statistical visualization beyond standard matplotlib capabilities may require manual customization.

4.10. Future Directions

~~SciTeX~~ Future development will extend SciTeX's AI-native capabilities, including automated figure refinement, semantic consistency checking, and context-aware citation recommendation. Deeper integration of HPC-native workflows, unified inspector interfaces across modules, and interactive provenance graph visualization are planned. The long-term vision is a research co-pilot capable of executing analyses, generating publication-ready figures, interpreting literature, and producing draft manuscripts while maintaining full transparency and human oversight.

5. Conclusions

~~example of the~~ SciTeX represents both an architectural framework and a practical tool for reproducible scientific research. By combining modular design with provenance-aware infrastructure and AI-native workflows, it provides an environment where researchers can focus on scientific reasoning rather than technical orchestration. This manuscript, prepared entirely within SciTeX, illustrates the platform's ability to describe, manage, and reproduce its own workflow.

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~~Data Availability Statement~~

6. Resource Availability

~~The~~

6.1. Lead Contact

Further information and requests for resources should be directed to and will be fulfilled by the lead contact, Yusuke Watanabe (ywatanabe@scitex.ai).

6.2. Materials Availability

This study did not generate new unique reagents.

6.3. Data and Code Availability

- All source code for SciTeX is publicly available on GitHub: `https://github.com/scitex-ai/scitex`
- The SciTeX Python package is available via PyPI: `pip install scitex`
- Documentation is available at~~.~~: `https://docs.scitex.ai`
- The cloud platform is accessible at: `https://scitex.ai`
- This manuscript's source files are included in the SciTeX Writer repository as a demonstration
- DOI for archived version: [Zenodo DOI to be assigned upon submission]

~~For questions regarding data access or analysis procedures, please contact the corresponding author~~All code is released under the GNU General Public License v3.0 (GPL-3.0), ensuring open access and modification rights. The platform follows FAIR principles (Findable, Accessible, Interoperable, Reusable) for all data and code artifacts.

Any additional information required to reanalyze the data reported in this paper is available from the lead contact upon request.

Ethics Declarations

All study participants provided their written informed consent ...

Author Contributions

Y.W., T.Y., and D.G. conceptualized the study ...

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Declaration of Interests

The authors declare that they have no competing interests.

Declaration of Generative AI in Scientific Writing

The authors employed large language models such as Claude (Anthropic Inc.) for code development and complementing manuscript's English language quality. After incorporating suggested improvements, the authors meticulously revised the content. Ultimate responsibility for the final content of this publication rests entirely with the authors.

Tables

Option	Description	Example
–engine ENGINE	Force specific compilation engine	–engine tectonic
–draft	Draft mode (single-pass compilation)	–draft
–no-figs	Skip figure processing	–no-figs
–no-tables	Skip table processing	–no-tables
–no-diff	Skip difference generation	–no-diff
–watch	Enable hot-recompile file watching	–watch
–clean	Clean build (remove all cache)	–clean
–verbose	Verbose compilation output	–verbose

Table 1 – Compilation Command-Line Options. Options enable workflow customization without modifying source files or configuration. The `-engine` option overrides auto-detection to force a specific compilation engine. Quick compilation modes (`-draft`, `-no-figs`, `-no-tables`) reduce build times from ∼15s to under 3s for rapid iteration. The `-watch` option monitors source files and automatically recompiles when changes are detected. Options can be combined (e.g., `./compile_manuscript.sh -draft -no-figs`).

Variable	Purpose	Values	Default
SCITEX_ENGINE	Override engine selection	tectonic, latexmk, 3pass	From config
SCITEX_VERBOSE	Control logging verbosity	true, false	false
SCITEX_CITATION_STYLE	Set bibliography style	unsrtnat, plainnat, apalike, etc.	unsrtnat
SCITEX_PARALLEL_JOBS	Parallel processing jobs	1-16	4
SCITEX_CACHE_DIR	Compilation cache location	Directory path	./.cache

Table 2 – **Environment Variables for System Configuration.** Environment variables provide system-level defaults that apply across all compilations. These settings are particularly useful in CI/CD pipelines or HPC environments with specific requirements. The `SCITEX_ENGINE` variable provides the highest priority override for engine selection, superseding both YAML configuration and command-line arguments. Variables can be set persistently in shell configuration (`.bashrc`, `.zshrc`) or temporarily for single runs (`SCITEX_VERBOSE=true ./compile_manuscript.sh`).

Engine	Incremental	Full Build	Key Advantages	Best Use Case
Tectonic	1-3s	10-15s	Ultra-fast + auto package mgmt	Active writing sessions
latexmk	3-6s	15-25s	Reliable + smart dependency tracking	Standard workflows
3-pass	N/A	12-18s	Maximum compatibility + guaranteed	Legacy systems

Table 3 – **Compilation Engine Performance Characteristics.** Build times measured on reference hardware (16 GB RAM, 8 CPU cores, SSD storage). Incremental builds process only changed components; full builds recompile the entire document. Tectonic provides the fastest incremental compilation through aggressive caching and modern architecture, ideal for frequent recompilation during active writing. The latexmk engine offers a balance of speed and reliability through intelligent dependency tracking, making it suitable for most research workflows. Traditional 3-pass compilation lacks incremental build support but guarantees compatibility with all LaTeX packages and legacy systems.

Figures

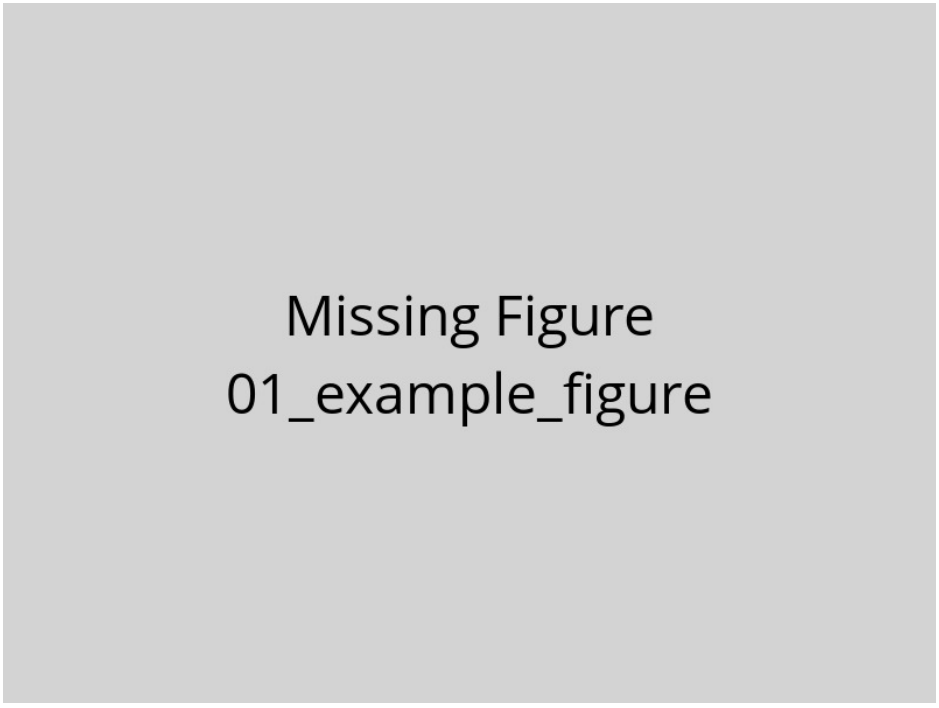

Figure 1 – Example figure caption. This is a template showing how to include figures in your manuscript. Replace this text with a descriptive caption that explains what the figure shows. Include panel labels (A, B, C) if using multi-panel figures. Explain abbreviations and symbols used in the figure. Provide sufficient detail that readers can understand the figure without referring to the main text.

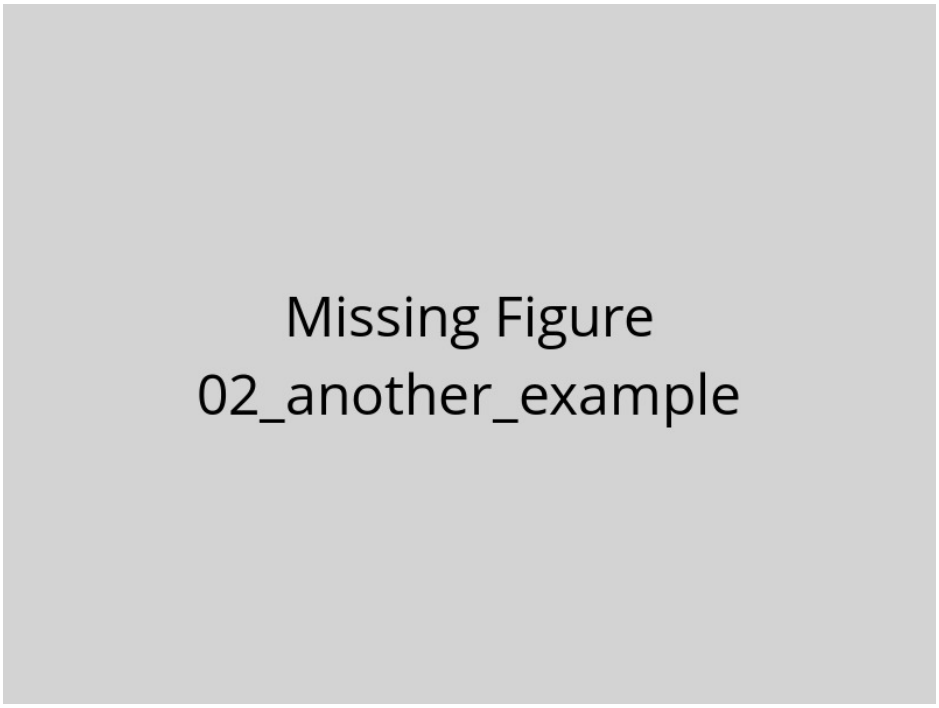

Figure 2 – Another example figure. Use this template to add additional figures to your manuscript. Each figure should be placed in a separate .tex file in this directory. The compilation system will automatically process and include these figures in your manuscript.

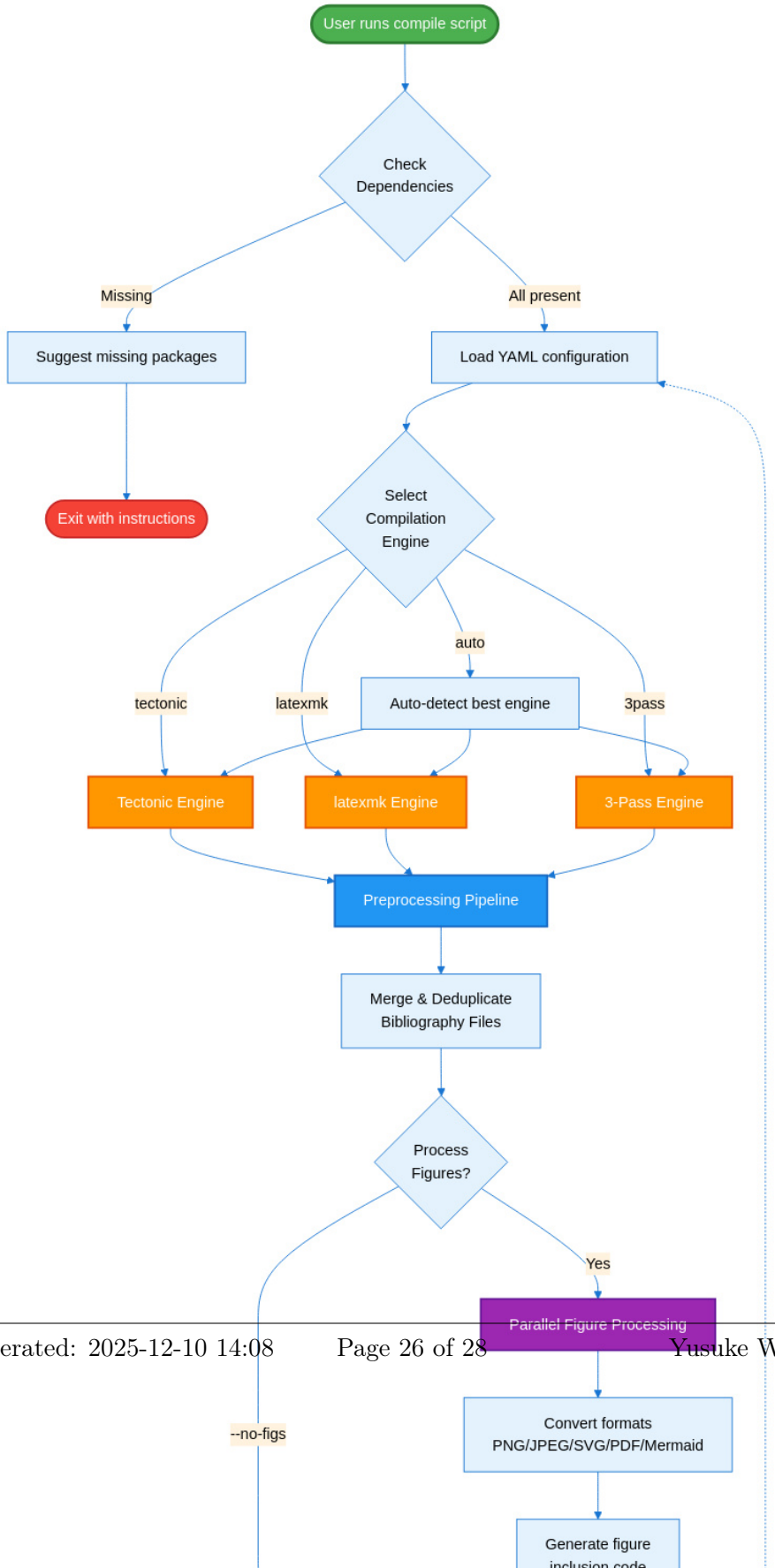
User runs compile script
Check Dependencies
Missing
All present
Suggest missing packages
Load YAML configuration
Exit with instructions
Select Compilation Engine
auto
tectonic
latexmk
Auto-detect best engine
3pass
Tectonic Engine
latexmk Engine
3-Pass Engine
Preprocessing Pipeline
Merge & Deduplicate Bibliography Files
Process Figures?
Yes
Parallel Figure Processing
--no-figs
Convert formats PNG/JPEG/SVG/PDF/Mermaid
Generate figure

Figure 4 – **SciTeX Writer Directory Organization.** This diagram shows the hierarchical organization of the repository structure. The `00_shared/` directory (green) contains resources used across all document types, including bibliography files and LaTeX styles, ensuring consistency without duplication. The three document directories (blue/purple) follow identical internal structures, facilitating familiarity and code reuse. Each document has its own `contents/` subdirectory with `figures/` and `tables/` organized into `caption_and_media/` (source files) and `compiled/` (generated LaTeX code). The modular structure minimizes merge conflicts during collaborative editing by isolating frequently-modified content files. Compilation scripts (orange) and configuration files (red) reside in dedicated directories for easy discovery and maintenance. Dotted lines indicate that supplementary materials follow the same organizational pattern as the main manuscript.

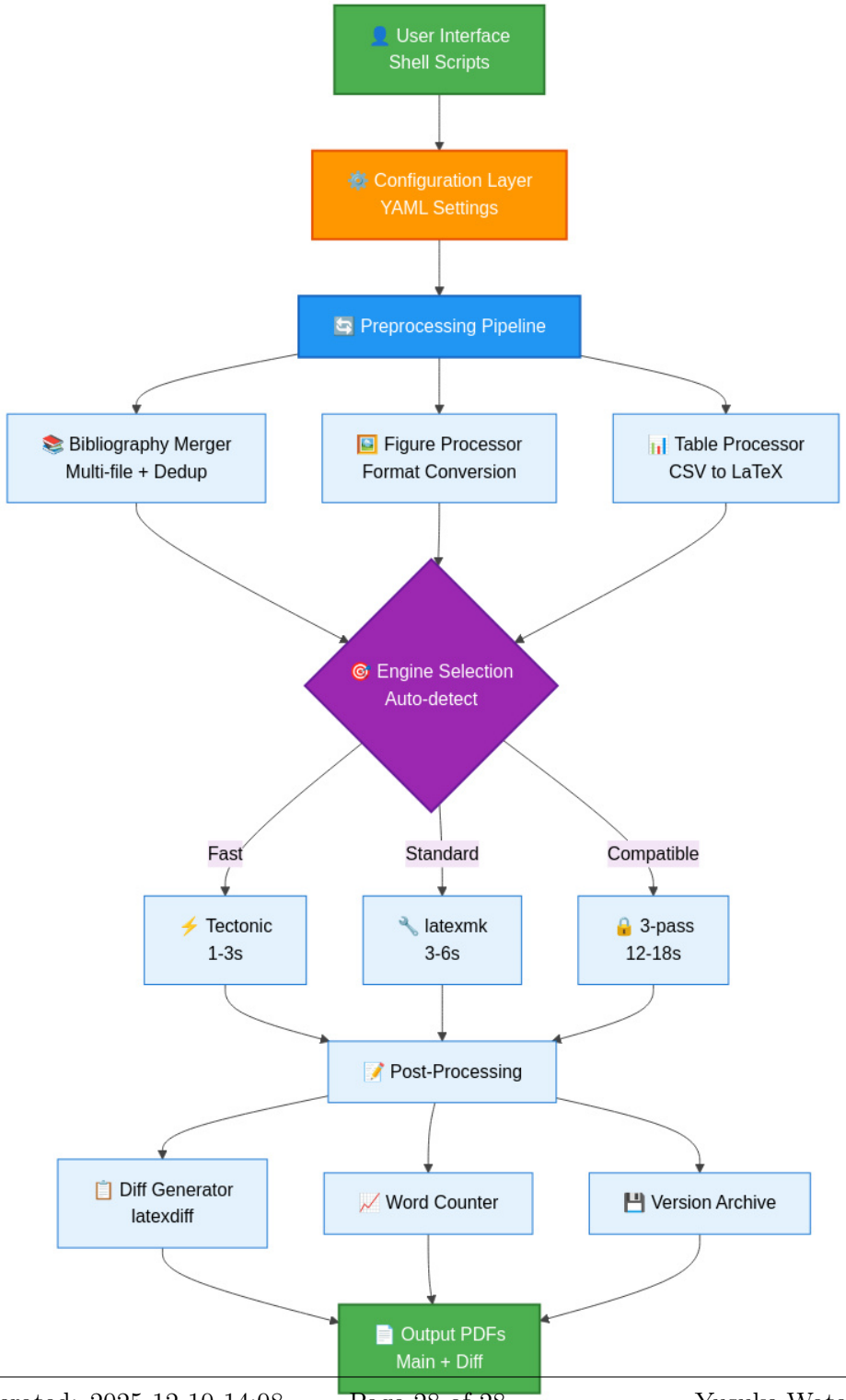

Figure 5 – **SciTeX Writer System Architecture.** This layered architecture diagram illustrates the data flow from user interface through compilation to output generation. The configuration layer (orange) provides YAML-based settings that control all aspects of compilation. The preprocessing pipeline (blue) handles bibliography merging, figure format

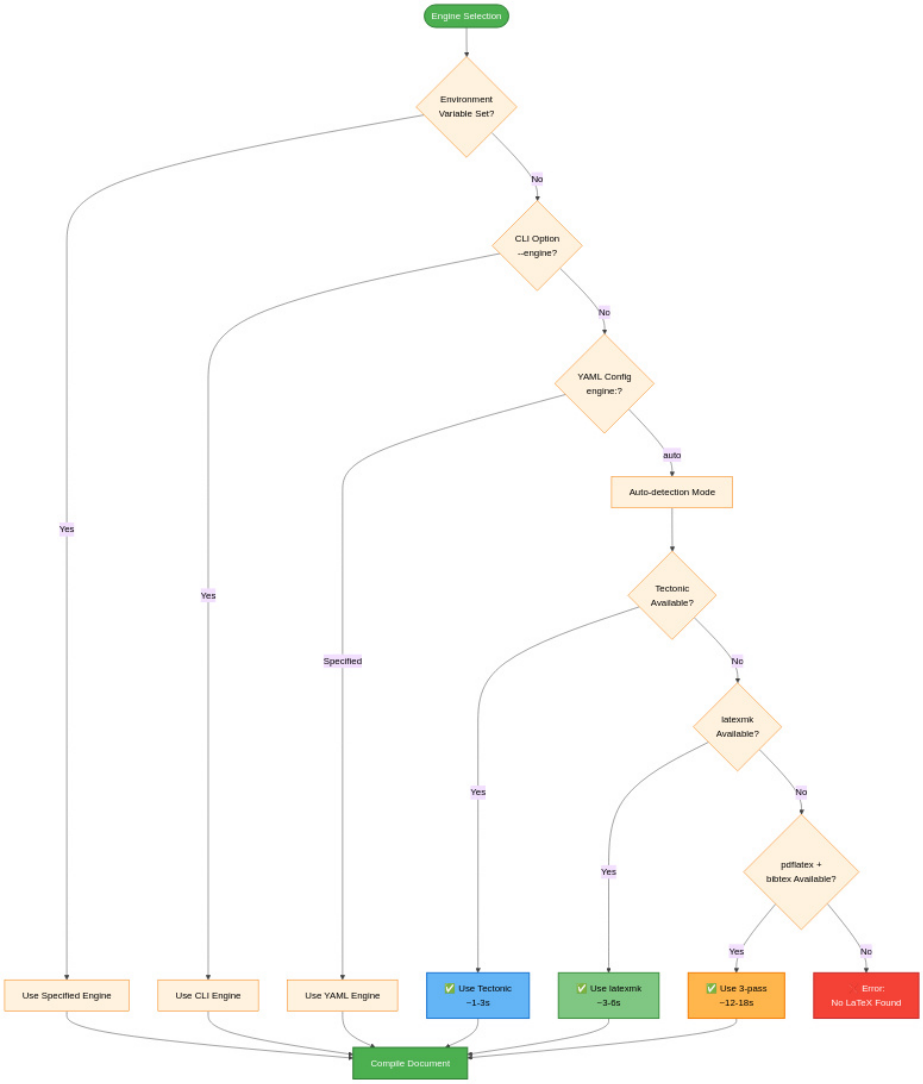

Figure 6 – **Compilation Engine Selection Decision Tree.** The system prioritizes explicit user configuration over automatic detection. Environment variables provide the highest priority override (useful for CI/CD pipelines). Command-line arguments (–engine) override YAML configuration (useful for one-off compilations). When engine is set to 'auto' (default), the system attempts to use Tectonic first for speed, falling back to latexmk for reliability, and finally to 3-pass for maximum compatibility. This cascading detection ensures the system always finds an available compilation method while preferring faster engines when possible. Times shown are typical incremental build durations on reference hardware (16 GB RAM, 8-core).

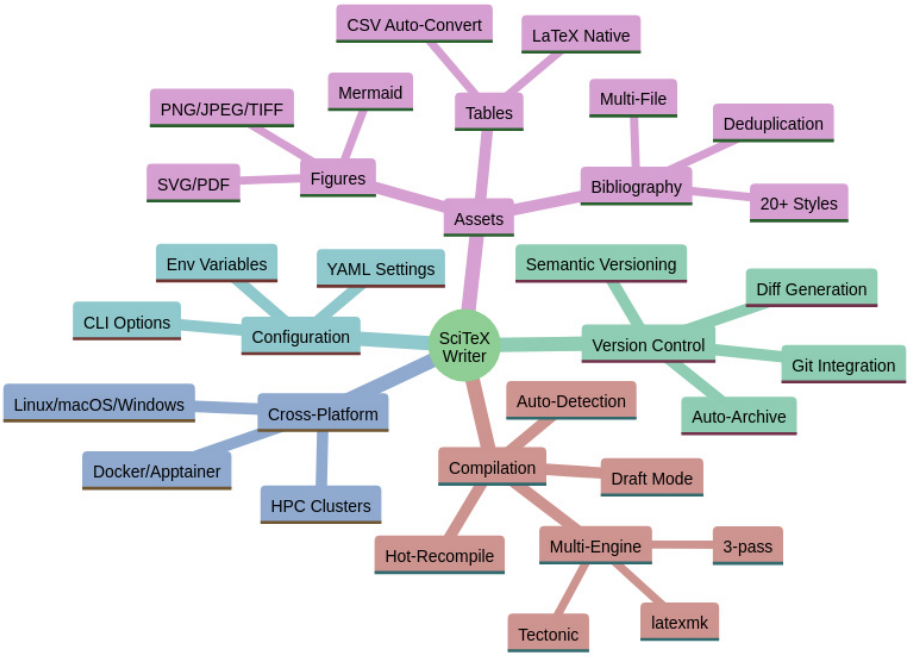

Figure 7 – **SciTeX Writer Feature Overview.** This mind map provides a comprehensive visualization of the framework's major capabilities organized into five categories. Compilation features include multi-engine support with auto-detection and performance optimization modes. Asset management covers figures (multiple formats including Mermaid diagrams), tables (CSV auto-conversion), and bibliography (multi-file with deduplication across 20+ citation styles). Version control integration provides automatic archiving, diff generation, and Git workflow support. Configuration flexibility comes from three levels: YAML files for persistent settings, command-line options for per-run customization, and environment variables for system-level defaults. Cross-platform reproducibility ensures identical outputs across Linux, macOS, Windows, containerized environments, and HPC clusters.

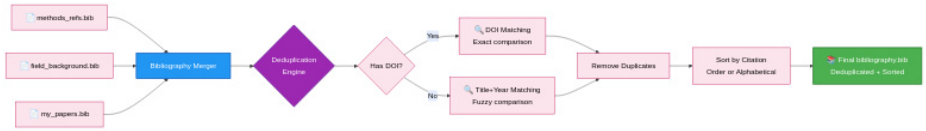

Figure 8 – Multi-File Bibliography Processing and Deduplication. The bibliography system enables researchers to organize references across multiple topical .bib files. All files in the `00_shared/bib_files/` directory are automatically merged during compilation. The deduplication engine implements a two-tier matching strategy: DOI-based matching provides exact duplicate detection when DOIs are present, while title and year matching handles entries without DOIs. This approach eliminates duplicate references that commonly appear when the same paper is cited across multiple source files. The final bibliography is sorted according to the selected citation style (by citation order for numbered styles, alphabetically for author-year styles). Color coding: blue (merging), purple (deduplication logic), green (output).